How to land brand deals with your reels

A practical playbook: which niches pay, what to charge (realistically), how to pitch without landing in spam, and how to grow to the point where brands email you first.

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1. Pick a niche brands pay for

Brands pay for attention from people who might buy. The closer your audience is to a purchase decision, the more each view is worth.

Niche	Who sponsors	Typical value
AI tools, SaaS, productivity, coding	AI startups, dev tools, no-code builders, browser extensions	High. Many startups have creator budgets and fast decisions
Business, marketing, freelancing	CRMs, email tools, website builders, course platforms, banks for freelancers	High
Personal finance, investing (careful: regulated)	Apps, brokers, budgeting tools	High, but strict compliance rules
Tech gadgets, explainers	Accessory brands, gadgets, VPNs, apps	Medium to high
Education, languages, careers	Learning apps, job platforms	Medium
Food, local business, lifestyle	Local brands, delivery apps, D2C products	Lower per view, more deals

Rules of thumb:

- Pick one niche and stay in it for at least 30 posts. Brands search by niche; a mixed feed looks risky to them.
- "How it works" and "tools I use" formats are naturally sponsorable: a product can slot into them without feeling like an ad.

2. What to charge (be realistic)

Price on **views, not followers**. Use the average views of your last 10 reels (ignore your single best one).

Base price per reel ≈ average views ÷ 1,000 × CPM

Niche	Realistic CPM (per 1,000 views)
AI / SaaS / B2B / finance	$10 to $25
Tech, education, business general	$7 to $15
Lifestyle, food, entertainment	$3 to $10

Examples:

- 15k average views in AI/SaaS: 15 × $15 = **~$225** per reel.
- 60k average views in AI/SaaS: 60 × $15 = **~$900** per reel.
- 200k average views in tech: 200 × $10 = **~$2,000** per reel.

Floors and add-ons:

- Set a floor ($150 to $300) so tiny accounts don't work for $40. Under ~5k average views, start with **affiliate deals** (a % of sales or a fixed fee per signup) or product-for-content, but only for products you'd actually use.
- **Usage rights** (they run your reel as an ad, "whitelisting" / "Spark ads"): +30% to +100% per month of usage.
- **Exclusivity** (no competitors for N days): +20% to +50%.
- **Rush** (post in under 5 days): +25%.
- **Bundles**: 3 reels = 10 to 15% off. Brands like recurring deals; you like predictable income.
- Script written and approved by them, extra revision rounds beyond 2: charge for it.

When they ask "what's your rate?", give one number with what's included, not a range. A range means they'll pick the bottom.

What a first year can realistically look like: your first deal will probably be small ($100 to $500). Once one brand renews, others notice. A few thousand dollars in the first months is a good result for an account with consistent views; it is not guaranteed and depends on your niche and views.

3. Get your ”storefront” ready before pitching

- **Bio**: who it's for + what you post + "Collabs: you@yourdomain.com".
- **Media kit** (a one-page site or PDF): average views (last 30 days), followers, audience top countries/ages (Instagram Insights), 3 best reels with numbers, past brands (if any), formats you offer, a contact email. Update it monthly.
- **A professional email on your own domain** (you@yourname.com). Gmail works, but your own domain gets opened more and is easier to keep out of spam (see section 5).
- **Proof**: screenshots of Insights for your best reels, kept current.

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4. Who to pitch and where to find them

- Products you already use and mention: start here. A brand you've organically featured is the warmest lead you'll ever have.
- Brands already sponsoring creators in your niche: look at "Paid partnership" labels on similar accounts; those brands have a budget and a process.
- Startups that just launched or raised money: Product Hunt, X/Twitter launches, newsletters in your niche.
- Creator marketplaces: Instagram's Creator Marketplace (in the Professional dashboard), Passionfroot, Collabstr. Fill your profile once; inbound comes slowly but it's free.
- The right person: Head of Marketing, Growth, Partnerships, "Creator/Influencer" manager, or the founder at small startups. LinkedIn + the company site will usually give you the name; their email format is often first@company.com.

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5. Pitch emails that get read (and don’t hit spam)

Deliverability basics

- Send from your own domain with **SPF, DKIM and DMARC** set up (your email provider's setup guide has a 10-minute checklist). Without them, your emails often go straight to spam.
- New address or domain? **Warm up**: send normal emails to people you know for 1 to 2 weeks before cold outreach.
- Send by hand, **10 to 30 cold emails per day max**. No mass tools at the start, no identical copy-paste.

- Plain text. **One link at most** (your media kit), no attachments in the first email, no images, no tracking pixels.
- Avoid spammy words and formatting: ALL CAPS, "!!!", "guaranteed", "free money", "act now", "100%".
- Personalise the first line for real (a specific post, product launch, feature).
- Follow up at most **twice** (day 4 and day 10). If someone says no or asks to stop, stop.

Template 1: cold pitch

Subject: {Brand} x {your handle}: a reel idea for {their audience}

Hi {Name},

I make short explainers about {niche} for {audience} on Instagram ({handle}, ~{avg views} average views per reel, mostly {top countries}).

I've been using {product} for {use case}, and I think a reel on "{specific angle, e.g. how I cut my client onboarding to 5 minutes with {product}}" would land well with my audience. My recent reel on {similar topic} got {views} views: {link}

I'd keep it in my usual format (it's a tutorial, not an ad) and you'd approve the script before anything goes live.

Want me to send a short concept and my rate?

{Name} {media kit link}

Template 2: after a reel popped

Subject: {views} views on a reel about {topic}, {Brand} fits it perfectly

Hi {Name}, quick one: my reel on {topic} just passed {views} views ({link}). The comments are full of people asking which tool to use for {problem}, which is exactly what {product} does. I'm planning a follow-up this week. Interested in being the featured tool? Happy to share numbers and a concept.

Template 3: follow-up (day 4)

Subject: Re: {original subject}

Hi {Name}, bumping this in case it got buried. I can have a concept to you within 24 hours if it's interesting. If someone else handles creator partnerships, I'd appreciate a pointer.

Template 4: final follow-up (day 10)

Subject: Re: {original subject}

Hi {Name}, last note from me on this. If the timing isn't right, no worries at all. I'll keep making {niche} content, and the offer stands whenever you're running creator campaigns.

Template 5: replying with your rate

Thanks {Name}! For one Instagram reel ({format}, ~{length} s) it's **${price}**, which includes: script for your approval, up to 2 rounds of revisions, posting on {date range}, and a performance report after 7 days (views, reach, saves, link clicks if you provide a tracked link). Usage rights for ads are +{x}% per month. If a bundle of 3 works better for you, it's ${bundle price}. Shall I send a concept?

Template 6: when they lowball

Thanks for the offer. My rate reflects my average of {avg views} views per reel in {niche}, which works out to about ${CPM} per 1,000 views. I can do ${slightly lower} if we make it a bundle of 2, or I can drop {an add-on: the report, the second revision round, the story} to meet ${their number + something}.

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6. Running the deal like a pro

1. **Get the brief in writing**: key message, must-say lines, link/promo code, posting date, tagging rules, what NOT to say, approval steps.
2. **Script first.** Send the script for approval before you make the video. Once a script is approved, don't change it.
3. **Send drafts low-res with a watermark** (so a draft can't be posted without paying). Final file after approval.
4. **Disclosure**: use Instagram's "Paid partnership" label and/or "#ad" as the law and the platform require where you and your audience are (e.g. FTC in the US, ASA in the UK). Ask the brand if they want the label tied to their account.
5. **Payment terms**: 50% upfront for new brands, or full payment within 14 days of posting. Send an invoice the day you post. For bigger deals, a short contract: deliverables, dates, usage rights, exclusivity, payment terms, revisions.
6. **Report after 7 days**: views, reach, likes, saves, shares, comments, link clicks/promo code uses if you have them. Brands renew creators who report without being asked.
7. **Ask for the renewal** in the same email as the report.

7. Grow until they come to you

- Post **consistently**: 1 reel a day or at least 4 a week, same niche, same format family. This skill exists exactly for this.
- Every reel ends with a reason to comment (a keyword + a resource). Comments push distribution, and keyword DMs grow a list you own.
- Feature tools you genuinely use, unpaid, with their handle in the caption. Brands track mentions; many first deals start as "we saw your reel about us".
- Turn your best-performing format into a series (Part 1, 2, 3). Series get followed; followers get you deals.
- Keep the "Collabs:" email in your bio and answer fast. Brands often contact 5 creators and book whoever replies first.
- Keep a simple sheet: brand, contact, date pitched, follow-ups, status, price. It turns pitching into a routine.

Numbers here are typical ranges, not promises. Your results depend on your niche, views and consistency.